

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 370

By Howell

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend the Copper Basin Lady Cougars basketball team upon winning its second consecutive District 5 tournament and earning a berth in the Class A state tournament.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly should salute those student athletes who, through their extraordinary efforts, have distinguished themselves as true champions of whom we can all be proud; and

WHEREAS, one such exemplary group of lasses is the Copper Basin High School Lady Cougars basketball team, whose members have proven themselves to be the fiercest of competitors and truly worthy of admiration by repeating as the TSSAA Class A District 5 tournament champions, having also won the tournament in 2024; and

WHEREAS, in the team's semi-final match-up of the tourney, Copper Basin demolished CSLA 74-43 to advance; and

WHEREAS, in the championship game, the Lady Cougars faced their arch rivals, the Sale Creek Lady Panthers, in a fierce cat fight that ended with Copper Basin winning 52-46 in overtime to bring home the gold; and

WHEREAS, in claiming the district tournament title, Copper Basin avenged its only district loss, having fallen to Sale Creek in the first game of the season; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Cougars advanced to the Class A East regional competition, where they trounced South Pittsburg 70-27 in the semi-final round and defeated Van Buren County 56-47 in the final to win the region championship; and

WHEREAS, matching up against Clay County in the sectional game, Copper Basin emerged victorious by a score of 57-49 to earn entry into the promised land of the Class A state tournament, where the team finished the season at 18-9; and

WHEREAS, Copper Basin relied heavily upon the talent, competitive spirit, and leadership of junior Alexis Hyatt, who led the Lady Cougars in scoring the last three seasons and has already scored more than 1,000 points in her high school career; and

WHEREAS, also contributing significantly to the Lady Cougars' title run were Kendra Deal, Cora Kimsey, Kloie Ballew, Addison Hyatt, Aeryayna Byrd, Reagan Hedden, Maleah Deal, Riley Akens, Kinsley Ross, Zoe Green, and Alyvia Harris; and

WHEREAS, the Lady Cougars' superb performance would not have been possible without the stellar leadership of Head Coach Jeff Grimes and Assistant Coach Rusty Boggs and the unfailing support of their families, their fans, and their community; and

WHEREAS, the members of the Copper Basin girls' basketball team epitomize all that is good in today's student athletes, as they have achieved a premier level of success in competition while exhibiting the highest degree of character in all aspects of life; and

WHEREAS, the perseverance, determination, work ethic, and talent of this group of young ladies not only made possible an outstanding season but also surely bode well for their future success; and

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to acknowledge and applaud the Copper Basin Lady Cougars for their outstanding season on the hardwood; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and commend the members and coaches of the Copper Basin High School Lady Cougars basketball team upon winning their second consecutive District 5 tournament, earning a berth in the Class A state tournament, and extend to them our best wishes for every continued success in all their future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.